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TAB 25



Board of Education Report

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In Control: Board of Education

Ms. Griego, Ms. Ortiz Franklin, Dr. Rivas - Strengthening and Expanding Community-Based Safety Programs in Time of Heightened Immigration Enforcement (Res-025-25/26) (For Action December 16, 2025)

Whereas, In October 2025, the Los Angeles County Board of Supervisors declared state of emergency through a “Proclamation of Local Emergency for Federal Immigration Actions” in order to provide those most impacted with resources including economic relief, eviction protections, and other assistance; and in December 2024, LA City Council unanimously adopted an ordinance in to prohibit the use of city resources, personnel, property and data for federal immigration enforcement;

Whereas, Since the beginning of 2025, in Los Angeles and across the region, communities have witnessed heightened attacks on our most vulnerable communities, including Black, LGBTQ+, and immigrants, as a result of policies and rhetoric enacted by the federal administration;

Whereas, As a result of those heightened attacks, Los Angeles Unified School District students and family members have been targeted, arrested, detained, and deported to their home countries within a matter of days;

Whereas, Communities are experiencing a widespread fear of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) raids, detentions, and deportations near and around our schools consequently creating chaos and economic uncertainty as a result of family separations, job loss, housing destabilization, and movement across the region;

Whereas, Recent immigration enforcement efforts have created fear, sorrow, and anxiety in our communities negatively impacting the mental health of young people. According to the 2025 BlueSky Youth Mental Health Survey, over 81 percent of youth respondents expressed concern with discrimination against immigrants;

Whereas, Particular communities across the greater Los Angeles region are being racially profiled and targeted. The map “Areas of Focus for Immigration Activity” produced by the Coalition for Humane Immigrant Rights (CHIRLA) highlighted the communities of the San Fernando Valley (Pacoima and North Hills), South LA (Jefferson Park and Westmont), Southeast LA (Norwalk, Bellflower, Downey, South Gate) as the communities with the highest immigration enforcement activity between June 6 and July 20, 2025;

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District has reaffirmed its commitment to making Los Angeles Unified School District a sanctuary district through resolutions “Reaffirmation of Los Angeles Unified School District Schools as Safe Zones for Families Threatened by Immigration Enforcement” (Res-093- 16/17), and “Reaffirm that Los Angeles Unified School District Will Be a Sanctuary District and Safe Zone for Families Threatened by Immigration Enforcement” (Res-034-24/25);

Whereas, In July of 2025, the Board unanimously approved the resolution “Upholding Our Constitutional Rights and Standing with Immigrant Communities” (Res-086-24/25) which condemns the militarization of immigrant communities, including any uninvited deployment of federal agents, National Guard personnel, in our schools and communities without local request and transparent civilian oversight;

Whereas, The District has responded by expanding the We Are One campaign, which includes Know Your Rights trainings, emergency preparedness plans, strengthening partnerships with community organizations and service providers, establishing and implementing protocols for when ICE attempts to enter our campuses, and other mental, financial and legal supports for impacted students and families;

Whereas, Community members, organizations and labor partners in the greater Los Angeles area have organized rapid response and mutual aid networks; organized and led Know Your Rights trainings for community members, students, and educators; documented ICE raids that have provided the basis for lawsuits against the federal administration; demonstrated a commitment to keeping our students safe by being present at schools during the first week of school; and communicating with board members and other District leaders to offer support;

Whereas, Through the unanimously approved “Community-Based Safety Analysis and Expansion” (Res-023-22/23) resolution, the District committed to implementing a holistic vision of school safety that called for a Community-Based Safety Pilot at Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP) schools incorporating safe passages, peacebuilding, and community development; and a Landscape Analysis Report produced by the Independent Analysis Unit to inform the expansion of community-based safety programs across the District;

Whereas, Community-Based Safety programs, when implemented with fidelity, create inclusive, supportive, and safe learning environments for Black, undocumented, LGBTQ+ students without criminalizing or harming students;

Whereas, The District allocated \$125 million in base funding and an additional \$50 million in one-time funding in the 2025-26 budget towards BSAP, which included funding to maintain and expand community-based safety program at BSAP schools;

Whereas, The District currently has over 170 active community-based safety programs, which include; more than 75 safe passage programs, approximately 60 peace building programs, and nearly 40 community development programs across BSAP schools; and

Whereas, The District has recently executed separate Memorandum of Understandings (MOU) with the Los County Office of Violence Prevention and the City of Los Angeles’s Gang Reduction and Youth Development Program (GRYD), leading to the initiation of a pilot safe passage program at Sotomayor Arts and Sciences Magnet, Bernstein High School and Virgil Middle School; now, therefore be it

Resolved, That in an effort to work towards creating a greater sense of safety on the route to and from school for students and families, the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recommits to the model of Community-Based Safety, which includes safe passage, peacebuilding and community development programs;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District will expand trainings for staff, students, and families on ICE protocols, Know Your Rights, de-escalation skill building, restorative justice, and peacebuilding,

Resolved further, That the District will execute a contract with an expert in the field of community-based safety by March 2026. As part of the contract, the expert will be hired to develop a cohesive plan for the expansion of community-based safety programs districtwide. The plan will be developed in collaboration with District staff, and local city and county experts, and shall include, but not be limited to, the following key components:

- 1) Standardize expectations to establish coherence among community-based safety vendors, and city and county partners,
- 2) Evaluation framework, metrics, and mechanisms to guide the outcomes and efficacy of the program and vendors,
- 3) Monitor and assess what types of community-based safety programs and strategies are working at schools and in the broader communities and identify model schools within the District,
- 4) Inform what other school districts are doing when it comes to community-based safety programs,
- 5) Recommendations on how to deepen community-based safety partnerships with government agencies, community groups, and non-profit organizations,
- 6) Vision and stricture for Community Based Safety Teams at schools, which may include safe passage staff, School Climate Advocates, and mental health professionals,
- 7) Communication and messaging plan to educate the school community on community-based safety programs,
- 8) Framework for engaging volunteers, including students, families, and local businesses, community-based safety education and programs,
- 9) Outline of additional investment and funding opportunities; and, be it finally,

Resolved, That the Board directs the Superintendent to present a long-term implementation plan of Community-Based Safety programs to the Board by December of 2026.